Combined with just a few simple ingredients, roasted potatoes can quickly be transformed into a luxuriously smooth, rich, and comforting winter soup.

roasted potato soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 15 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
BEFORE ONION AND BACON ARE ADDED

1lb (450g) floury potatoes, such as Russet, cut into 2in (5cm) chunks
2 tbsp olive oil
salt and freshly ground black pepper
3 large shallots, coarsely chopped
2 garlic cloves, halved
1 large parsnip, cut into small chunks
3¾ cups hot vegetable stock
4 slices bacon, cut into thin strips
1 onion, halved lengthwise and thinly sliced
¼ cup heavy cream
2 tbsp butter

1 Preheat the oven to 400˚F (200˚C). Put the potatoes and 1 tbsp of the oil into a small roasting pan and toss to coat well. Season with freshly ground black pepper, then roast for 45 minutes or until golden. Turn occasionally to ensure even roasting. Transfer to a large pot and add the shallots, garlic, and parsnip. Add the stock, bring to a boil, then cover with a lid and simmer for 20 minutes or until the parsnip is tender.

2 Meanwhile, heat the remaining oil in a frying pan, add the bacon, and fry for 5 minutes or until crisp. Remove with a slotted spoon and drain on paper towels. Add the onion along with a pinch of salt, and cook over medium heat for 8–10 minutes or until dark golden brown and well caramelized. Set to one side and keep warm.

3 Remove the soup from the heat, add the cream and butter, and stir until the butter has melted. Process in a blender or food processor until smooth. You may need to do this in batches. Add a little more stock if the soup is too thick. For an extra smooth soup, press the mixture through a fine sieve. Season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then reheat gently and serve topped with the crispy onion and bacon.